India's commitment to peace and friendship with Maldives. The President of the Republic of Maldives, H.E. Mr Ibrahim Mohamed Solih, State Visit to India from 16-18 December 2018, keeping India first policy is yet another opportunity for both counties to come together for a closer relationship. As a step towards furthering closer relations between both countries, India promised $1.4 billion financial assistance package for socio-economic development of the island nation.

Way forward: Recent change in the attitude of Maldivian government is an opportune moment for India to redraw bilateral relations between both by helping Maldives to resuscitate its economy. Some major area of confidence building are

- Investment cooperation with Maldives should be enhanced by establishing an advisory cell to guide all stake-holders i.e. Indian missions overseas and prospective Indian investors, to delineate touchy areas and risky investments, with full knowledge of the local conditions.
- 'Free-Purse' policy of aid to Maldives is needed if India wants to offset Chinese big-ticket investments in Maldives.
- India must enhance anti-terrorism cooperation and intensify cooperation in the areas of training and capacity building of the Maldives National Defense Force and the Maldives Police Service.
- A regular bilateral security dialogue amongst the officials of both sides should be instituted to expand the scope of security cooperation. This should be supplemented by Track-II and Track-1.5 dialogues.
- While dealing with smaller neighbors like Maldives, India needs to become a lot more magnanimous, staying true to its own "Gujral Doctrine," thus creating greater confidence.
- The SAARC and IORA can provide a platform to work on lingering concerns. Moreover, India, Maldives and Sri Lanka can explore ways to strengthen trilateral mechanisms to address these issues.

Glossary

- **MOU:** Memorandum of understanding between two or more nations which further strengthen the policies economic cultural or other relations.
- **NWFP:** Federally administered province in India during British rule.
- **Diplomacy:** It is an Institution or concept which enthuse relations among nation.
- **WTO:** World Trade Organization is a trade organization to formulate economic and trade policies between the nations of the world.
- **SAARC:** South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation is a regional organization for strengthening cooperation among the countries in South Asia.
- **Trust Deficit:** it is the diplomatic factor concerned with the strained relations between Nations.
- **NAM:** Non-Aligned Movement is an organization established by third world countries to keep themselves neutral.
- **SPDC:** State Peace and Development Council is an official name of Military Government of Burma.
- **Bretton Woods System:** It established the rules for commercial and financial relations among the world.
- **Super Power:** Super power countries are economically and militarily advanced.

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